Spartanburg District Four Generative AI Guidelines: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Generative AI Guidelines 2026-2027 (Spartanburg School District Four, South Carolina; last update July 6, 2026)*. Page numbers match the document's own page numbering. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text.

Ethical and Effective Use of AI (excerpt)

Source: page 4

AI tools and applications should be used in ways that support teaching, learning, and school operations while respecting the rights, privacy, and dignity of all students, families, and staff members.

Employees and students are expected to:

- Protect student and staff privacy by following all district policies and data security guidelines when using AI platforms or applications.

Generative AI Implementation Plan (excerpt)

Source: page 7

Phase 1: Guidance and Policy Focus: Foundation for safe use

- Data Privacy and Security

Benefits & Risks of AI (excerpt)

Source: page 8

Privacy: Risks associated with inputting student data … into models.

Protecting Data Privacy

Source: page 17

Personally Identifiable Information (PII) must never be entered into any AI platform.

Prohibited Information (What NOT to Share):

- **Identity:** Names, addresses, phone numbers, SSNs, or birth dates.
- **Educational Records:** Grades, transcripts, IEPs, or disciplinary records.
- **Health Information:** Medical records, therapy notes, or allergy information.
- **Financial Info:** Family income or bank details.
- **Photos or Videos:** Images or recordings of students.
- **Communication:** Personal logs, emails, or student-teacher messages.

Best Practices for Anonymizing Data*

- **Remove PII:** Exclude all identifiers from prompts entirely.
- **Generalize Information:** Describe educational needs (e.g., "a student struggling with phonics") rather than specific student details.

- **Use Hypothetical Scenarios:** Create "mirror" scenarios that reflect a student's educational context without revealing their identity.

Privacy Protocol: Minimal Disclosure

Even with strict safeguards, data fragments can sometimes be reassembled to identify an individual. To mitigate this risk, adhere to the principle of data minimization. Share only the essential information required for context and support; protecting privacy is most effective when you limit the details provided.

Employees are required to complete annual training regarding FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act).

Questions regarding PII or FERPA should be directed to school adminstration.

*Examples from Eric Curts of Control Alt Achieve
https://www.controlaltachieve.com/2024/03/ai-tools-and-student-data-privacy.html

MagicSchool Guidelines (excerpt)

Source: page 18

Spartanburg School District Four’s adopted AI platform for students is MagicSchool ONLY. Other platforms utilized by students are in direct violation of Spartanburg School District Four’s Acceptable Use Guide.

Age Restrictions: MagicSchool, an AI platform built for K-12, allows users of any age. Student users are added to the platform and supervised by their teacher.

COPPA Compliance: MagicSchool AI and other tools must be used in accordance with the Children’s Online Privacy Protection Act. Use for students under 13 requires strictly district-approved, "built-for-education" models.

AI Literacy: Before any student is permitted to use MagicSchool AI, students will receive annual instruction on AI literacy (including but not limited to fact-checking, formal/informal citations, and data privacy protections) to understand the technology's limitations, ethical implications, and Spartanburg School District Four’s policies.